

◆ Flush.

◆ Say “yes” to those who need help before they ask.

3. Assure that your children won’t realize you’re affluent until after they have established a mature, disciplined, and adult lifestyle and profession.

Once again, Dr. North said it best:

I have set up trusts for my children ... some estate tax advantages. But my plan will not distribute money to my children until they are forty years of age or older. Because in this way my money will have little effect on their way of life at that age. They will have already adopted their own lifestyle.

Dr. North also told us that he never gives his children cash gifts, not even now that they are adults.

Cash gives them too many options, ... especially in the case of young children. Media, especially TV, controls the values of our young. Just like they try to control what we think is funny with canned laughter.... [There’s] too much emphasis on consumption.... I have never just given cash for this reason. What I have always told my children [is] if you need to make a major purchase, you first must fund a good bit of it yourself.

4. Minimize discussions of the items that each child and grandchild will inherit or receive as gifts.

Never make light of verbal promises: “Billy, you will get the house; Bob, the summer cottage; Barbara, the silver,” especially in a group setting, especially when consuming alcohol. You may too easily forget or